



Figure 3: Dolphin with split window and terminal panel



Figure 4: Turtle Activity in Sugar

This is much easier than mirroring a repository locally. Only the packages required by at least one machine are downloaded, only when needed.

Disappointments

1. I am disappointed that Presto and Delta RPMs did not become a part of the Fedora 10 repositories. These will have to wait till Fedora 11. The Fedora 10 Delta RPMs are available for i386 using the Yum repository setting `baseurl=http://lesloueizeh.com/f10/i386/updates` in `fedora-updates.repo`. For the first update, I needed to download only 21 MB instead of the 111 MB if the full RPMs were downloaded. At the time of writing, Delta RPMs were not available for x86_64. See fedorahosted.org/presto for the current status.
2. Once in a while, when the system checks a disk at boot time, the boot-up delay can be long, but there is no feedback on the GUI to the users, asking them to be patient.
3. The Intel display driver caused a machine (three years old) to hang. The problem is with kernel 2.6.27 and not with

Fedora 10, per se. I faced a similar problem on Fedora 9 and Ubuntu 8.10 as well. The workaround is to add the following option in the device section of *xorg.conf*:

Option "NoAccel" "True"

4. The other disappointment has nothing to do with Fedora. The list of mirrors selected for India points to countries around us—Taiwan, Japan, Russia, etc. I needed to change the mirror list manually to point to the US servers for better, more consistent performance. My disappointment is that no Indian ISP is mirroring the common distributions even though the ISP would save on substantial international bandwidth. The couple of Indian mirrors available do not have adequate bandwidth and, in my experience, have normally been inaccessible.

Wish list

1. I would like to see Delta RPM support even for upgrading a distribution.
2. I would like PulseAudio server to just work even on remote desktops. The default setting of the `PULSE_SERVER` variable should be picked up from the `DISPLAY` variable.
3. I would like to see Firefox 3.1 available on Fedora 10 and not have to wait for Fedora 11.
4. I would like to see GNOME 2.6 included in Fedora 10, with an option to roll back to 2.4, if I so desire.
5. Actually, I would like to be able to upgrade my installation continuously and not ever face another new version. (More on that in *LINUX For You*, April 2008; PDF version available in the magazine section of the *LFYCD*.)

Recommendations

1. The new versions of distributions contain very little that is substantially different from earlier versions. Most of the packages are minor upgrades, with improvements and security fixes. The major issues with a distribution are resolved very quickly and it does not make sense to wait months or years for the distribution to be stable!
2. It is easier to work with OpenOffice.org 3 on Fedora 10 than to install and maintain it on your own on a lower version.
3. An upgrade is like an insurance policy. If I need to work with a recent application, the chances are that I would find it in the latest distributions. For example, it is much easier to explore the Sugar environment on Fedora 10 than on the earlier distributions.
4. Finally, upgrading a distribution keeps getting easier and less prone to problems with add-on packages.

Hence, should you upgrade? A reasonable position is, "Why not!" 

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